United Nations Development Programme

CLIMATE PROMISE



# Promoting Renewable Energy Access through Productive Uses of Electricity

Project Budget: USD 291,600

**IMPLEMENTING PARTNER** Ministry of Energy

**COOPERATING PARTNERS** The Governments of Belgium, Germany, Iceland, Italy Japan, Portugal, Sweden, Spain and UK

**TARGETED GROUPS** People living in rural and remote Zambia

## Context

Zambia's 2021 updated National Determined Contributions (NDC) prioritizes renewable energy and energy efficiency to achieve a low-carbon, climate-resilient future, with mini-grids critical for addressing rural electrification gaps. The Government's Rural Electrification Master Plan targets 66% national coverage and highlights off-grid solutions, though past efforts have often overlooked community needs. This UNDP Climate Promise project promotes the Productive Use of Electricity (PUE) in mini-grids to enhance energy access, improve livelihoods, and foster community ownership. Through participatory planning, gender-responsive approaches, and innovative business models like appliance-based financing, it aims to align mini-grid systems with local priorities, particularly benefiting women and youth, while supporting activities such as irrigation, agro-processing, refrigeration, and clean cooking.

## Objectives

Enhanced community resilience and sustainable natural resource management

Promote access to clean, gender-responsive energy solutions at scale

Strengthen institutional and community capacity for climate change adaptation and disaster risk reduction

## Expected Results



By 2027, Zambia's ecosystems are healthier and vulnerable groups are more resilient to climate shocks.



Clean energy access is expanded through gender-responsive public and private sector solutions.



Institutions and communities have increased capacity to implement climate and disaster risk reduction commitments.

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